

Fuel To Perform With Nutrition & Hydration

Myth Busting

- Believing that eating to live longer will be enough motivation to make consistently good nutrition decisions. It is better to eat for short term productivity like having a healthy and fulfilling super food salad at lunch to keep you at the top of your game for an important afternoon of work or play.
- Fat makes you fat. It turns out that we need between 15-35% of our total calorie intake from fat as fat is not all bad and is actually very important for healthy immune function and to absorb certain vitamins.

The Triangle Of Focus

- Do you want mostly performance, health or body composition? Perhaps you're somewhere in the middle of all three...
- What you eat, how much you eat and when you eat should be tailored towards your life goals e.g. a 09.00-17.00 office worker who is also marathon training would need more carbohydrates than a more sedentary office worker.
- For somebody targeting weight loss then they actually need to create a calorie deficit where they consume less calories through food than the amount of energy their body expends in a given day.
- People who just want a generally healthy lifestyle may be more likely to buy ethically sourced foods from health food shops and/or may consider a Vitamin D3 supplement during the winter months.

Transforming Principles

- For some period of time at least, track your food by using an app, the notes function on your phone, a pen and paper or simply mentally note the effect your food decisions have on you e.g. I feel constantly sluggish after an Irish fry for breakfast. Tracking on an app has an added benefit as it helps us to become calorie aware.
- Surround yourself with good food. Sounds simple but the data is damning. Cornell University studied photographs of 200 American kitchens and found that people who had breakfast cereals sitting on their counters weighed 20-lbs more than those who didn't (over a stone). On the other hand, those who had a fruit bowl out in the open weighed nearly 13-lbs less (nearly a full stone lighter). To me, that seems like a pretty remarkable finding.
- Target some simple swaps that work for you and your goal. A gym goer might find that they see more gains from their gym work by increasing their protein intake. Somebody eating for greater energy might ditch the heavy sandwiches at lunch and replace them with a fruit salad and yogurt or soup.

